

PULSEGUARD TECHNOLOGIES INC. - STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

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Title: REMOTE WORK EXPECTATIONS AND PROCEDURES
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1. PURPOSE & OBJECTIVE

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines remote work expectations, core working hours, communication parameters, and expense reimbursement processes for remote employees at PulseGuard. The goal is to maximize employee productivity, ensure business continuity, maintain data security, and facilitate structured reimbursements.

2. SCOPE

This procedure is applicable to all remote-first employees, hybrid workers, and contract staff working off-site within any department of PulseGuard Technologies Inc. It applies across all geographical work zones.

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1. Remote Employee

- Remains reachable and responsive during core working hours.
- Sets up a private and secure home workspace.
- Wears appropriate business attire during video calls.

3.2. Team Manager

- Conducts daily team check-ins (standups).
- Monitors team communication response times.
- Approves expense submissions for office upgrades.

3.3. HR Coordinator

- Audits remote workspace compliance profiles.
- Process remote work applications and ergonomic gear requests.

4. DEFINITIONS AND REFERENCES

- Core Working Hours: Mandatory daily windows where all remote personnel must be online and responsive.
- Slack Latency: The maximum delay permitted for responding to direct text messages during working hours.
- SOP-HR-002: Employee Onboarding & Verification (reference document).

5. CORE WORKING HOURS AND AVAILABILITY MANDATES

All remote employees must abide by the following operational availability rules:

5.1. Daily Core Schedule

- All remote employees must be active, online, and accessible during the mandatory collaborative core hours: 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM EST.
- Exceptions must be approved in writing by the Team Manager 24 hours in advance, or logged under formal leave policies.

5.2. Daily Standup Attendance

Attendance at the daily department standup is mandatory. Standup timings are fixed by the team lead and must occur within core hours.

5.3. Communication Latency Limits

- Response times on direct company messaging tools (Slack, Teams) during core working hours must not exceed 60 minutes.
- If an employee is offline or in a meeting, they must update their

status
icon and calendar accordingly.

6. SECURE HOME WORKSPACE PROTOCOLS

Employees are responsible for ensuring their home office environment is secure:

- 6.1. Private Connection
 - Remote work must be done over the company-provided VPN.
 - Open public Wi-Fi networks are strictly forbidden.
- 6.2. Visual Privacy
 - Monitors displaying customer PII or engineering codebase logs must not be visible to third parties, including family members.

7. ERGONOMIC HOME OFFICE EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT

PulseGuard provides financial support for setting up a healthy remote workspace:

- 7.1. Funding Limits
 - Remote employees are eligible for up to \$500 total reimbursement for approved home office ergonomic chairs, desks, and external monitors.
- 7.2. Receipt Submission Rules
 - To qualify for reimbursement, receipts must be submitted via the HR Portal within 30 days of purchase.
 - Submissions made 31 days or more post-purchase will be rejected.

8. PROCEDURAL STEP-BY-STEP FLOW

- Step 1: Employee applies for remote-work status through the HR portal.
- Step 2: Manager approves remote status based on performance.
- Step 3: Employee purchases ergonomic chair (under \$500 limit).
- Step 4: Employee logs receipt in HR reimbursement system within 30 days.
- Step 5: HR Coordinator reviews request and checks timestamp.
- Step 6: Finance issues reimbursement on the next pay cycle.
- Step 7: Employee maintains 10:00 AM - 4:00 PM availability and VPN security daily.

9. TROUBLESHOOTING & ESCALATION PROCEDURES

- 9.1. Responsiveness Failures
 - If an employee fails to respond within 60 minutes multiple times, the manager will log a performance incident and notify HR.
- 9.2. Escalation Contact Path
 - First Level: Department Team Manager.
 - Second Level: HR Director (Kavita Sharma).
 - Executive Escalation: VP of Engineering (Sneha Deshmukh).

10. REVISION HISTORY LOG

Version	Date	Author	Description of Change
v1.0	2024-04-10	K. Sharma	Initial release of remote work policy.
v2.0	2025-03-01	K. Sharma	Introduced the \$500 ergonomic fund.
v3.2	2026-01-15	K. Sharma	Added core hours 10 AM-4 PM EST rules.